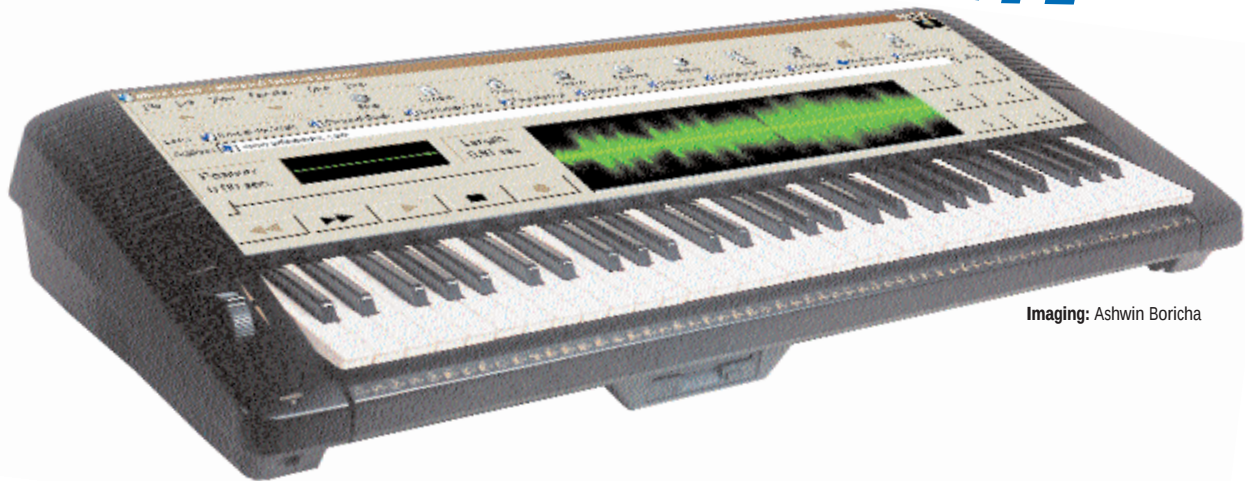


Virtual Jammin'



Imaging: Ashwin Boricha

Make your browser a turntable as you mix, scratch, loop and jam your way to becoming a virtual DJ

AVINA LOBO

You're at a disco, grooving to some awesome remixes, wondering what it would be like to create some cool music yourself. Wish you hadn't ditched music lessons in school for cricket? Well, you can put that thought to rest, because you don't really need to know much about music or spend a bomb on players and mixers to get started with mixing tracks and jamming online.

Musical and interactive

The Internet has shaken up the music industry in almost every conceivable way—from the composition of music to its distribution. MP3s are now an integral part of our lives and we don't need to take stock of the millions of people logging onto Audiogalaxy to realise this.

Whether you're a musician, composer or just a music enthusiast, the Web has a lot to offer you—information on composers and instruments, online interactive tutorials, free music files and music notation software. There's an entire range of software that can turn your PC into a synthesizer, enabling you to compose music from your keyboard in almost any form using almost any musical instrument.

The Web is also changing the way music can be rendered. Traditionally, music is a linear art form performed by musicians from beginning

to end and heard by a usually passive audience. But online, it's the audience or users that have the ability to modify and control their musical experience, as in computer games or certain Web sites.

Creating music using an interactive media such as the Internet is a fledgling art form. But this doesn't stop online music from becoming truly interactive, thanks to applications such as Shockwave and Flash. Web pages with Shockwave plugins let you play around with music online, not just listen to it. You can do this with just your mouse, keyboard and at least a 56K Internet connection.

The applications designed to let you mix music online range from simple 'sound toys' that let you play around with a few sounds, save and e-mail your mix to sophisticated mixers with plenty of controls and tweaks that let you mix a large number of tracks simultaneously, upload your own files, add sound effects and broadcast your work.

Sound toys

If you're new to mixing music online then you should check out these cool sound toys to get a taste of what it's like to make music (or a lot of noise) on your browser.

Surf over to www.pianographique.com, a well-designed sound toy that lets you play a variety of

